

Geosyncline is an obsolete concept which means linear trough of subsidence of the Earth's crust within which vast amounts of sediment accumulate. Ganga Plain can be best described as a geosyncline. Peneplain means a more or less level land surface produced by erosion over a long period. Pediplain is a broad, relatively flat rock surface formed by the joining of several pediments. Pediplains are usually formed in arid or semi-arid climates and may have a thin veneer of sediments. Karst plain can be best described as a limestone plain.

15. Which one of the following statements about the Indian desert is/are correct?

- The Indian desert lies towards the western margins of the Aravalli Hills
- This region receives very low rainfall below 150 mm per year
- Luni is the only large river in this region
- All the above.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The Indian desert is popularly known as the Thar desert. The Indian desert lies towards the western margins of the Aravallis Hills. It is an undulating sandy plain covered with sand dunes. This region receives very low rainfall below 150 mm per year. It has an arid climate with low vegetation cover. Luni is the only large river in this region. Hence, all three statements are correct.

ii. Northern Mountainous Region

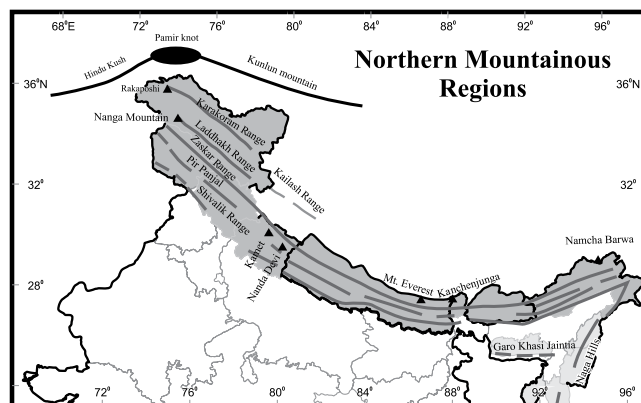
Himalaya is the highest mountain range in the world. *Himalaya spreads to a length of **2500 km** and from East to West. Its width varies between 160-400km. from North to South. We see more variation in Himalayan heights in the western part than in the eastern region.

*Himalayas can be divided into 3 parallel structural regions-

- Great Himalaya** (Himadri)
- Middle Himalaya** (Lesser Himalaya)
- Outer Sub-Himalaya** (Shiwalik)

*Great Himalaya is the oldest range, formed in the Eocene and Oligocene epochs (37-24 million years ago). Afterwards, the middle Himalaya was formed in the Miocene epoch (24-5 Million years ago) and the Shiwalik, the earliest one, was formed in the Pliocene epoch (5-2 million years ago).

*Mountain Range situated in the northern part of the Himalayas is called the Greater or Higher Himalayas or Himadri. It is the most continuous range which has the highest peaks with an average height of 6000 meters.



***Mt. Everest** is the highest peak in the world located in the Great Himalayas. It is situated on the boundary of Nepal and Tibet. ***Kanchenjunga**, the third highest peak in the world, lies in the Himalayas. It lies between the Teesta River in the east and the Tamur River in the west. Kanchenjunga lies on the border of eastern Nepal and the Sikkim state of India. ***Annapurna** Peak is located in north - central Nepal. **Dhaulagiri Peak** also lies in the Western Part of Nepal.

The core of this part of the Himalaya is made up of Granite. This range is always covered with snow. The Himalayas contain a number of Glaciers, therefore Himalayan Rivers are perennial. Ranges situated in the south of the Great Himalaya are called Lesser Himalaya/ Middle Himalaya. Its height lies between 3700 meters to 4500 meters and the average width is 50 km. Pir Panjal is the longest range in the Middle Himalayas. **Dhauladhar** and **Mahabharat ranges** are also important. Kashmir, Kangra and Kullu valleys of Himachal Pradesh are located in this range.

*The outermost range of the Himalayas is called Shiwalik. Its width is between 10 to 50 km and height between about 900m to 1100m. These ranges are formed by - unconsolidated sediments brought by Rivers from Great Himalaya. *The longitudinal valley lying in between the Lesser Himalaya and the Shiwaliks is called duns. *Some famous duns are - Dehradun, Kotlidun and Patlidun. *The plain that lies in the foothills of Shiwalik and longitudinally between the Indus in the west and Teesta in the east is called **Bhabar**. Bhabar is a narrow belt of land about 8 to 16 km wide covered with pebbles deposited by the rivers and lying parallel to the slopes of the Shiwaliks.

It is an alluvial fan structure made of riverine deposits. The width of the Bhabar plain is greater in the west than in the east. ***Tarai** is a 15-30 kilometer wide marshy area south of Bhabar. The Trans Himalaya is located to the north of Great Himalaya. **The Pamir knot** is also located in the

Trans Himalaya (Tibet). **The Karakoram mountain** range is a part of Trans- Himalaya. **The Kailash mountain** a holy shrine of Hindu religion, also lies in the western part of the Trans - Himalaya.

*Himalaya is divided into various sub-regions from west to east. These divisions are based on the borders of river valleys. The **Kashmir/Punjab/Himachal Himalayas** lie between Indus and Sutlej rivers. **The Kumaon Himalaya** lie between Satluj and Kali rivers. **Nepal Himalaya** lies between Kali and Teesta rivers. **Assam Himalaya** lies between Teesta and Dihang rivers.

*Brahmaputra River forms the easternmost boundary of Himalaya. Himalaya spreads along the eastern border of India after crossing **Dihang Gorge** in the south. These expansions are called Purvanchal or Eastern Hills. These are located in North-Eastern states of India.

The eastern extension of Himalaya includes **Dafla hills, Mishmi hills, Abor hills, Patkai hills, Naga hills, Mizo hills** and **Manipur hills**.

1. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the code given below :

Assertion (A) : All rivers originating from the Himalayas are perennial.

Reason (R) : Himalayas receive much of their precipitation from South-Western monsoon.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (b)

The rivers originating from the Himalayas are perennial because their source is located in the Himalayan glaciers. The Himalaya receives much of its rain from the south-western monsoon. Assertion and Reason both are true. However Reason (R) does not explain the Assertion (A) correctly.

2. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as-

Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The Himalayas are still rising.

Reason (R) : The Indian tectonic plate is colliding with the Eurasian plate.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) is false, but (R) is true.
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

UPPSC (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The Himalayas are newly folded mountains of the Alpine orogeny, containing many of the world highest peaks. The height of the Himalayas is continuously increasing at a rate of approximately 5mm per year (according to some reliable sources, more than 1 cm per year). The Himalayas are young and tectonically active. Around 40-50 million years ago, when the Indian tectonic plate (a part of the larger Indo-Australian plate) moved northward (currently northeast) and collided with the Eurasian plate, the debris from the Tethys geosyncline between them was uplifted leading to the formation of the Himalayan mountain range.

3. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the code given below :

Assertion (A) : All rivers originating from the Himalayas are perennial.

Reason (R) : Source of Himalayan rivers is located in glaciers.

Code :

- (a) (A) is false, but (R) is true
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
- (d) (A) is true, but (R) is false.

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) (2013)

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. **The Himalayas are formed of parallel fold ranges, of which the oldest range is –**

- (a) The Shiwalik Range
- (b) The Lesser Himalayas
- (c) The Great Himalayan Range
- (d) The Dhauladhar Range

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

On the basis of folds and age of formation, the Himalayas are divided into three parallel structural areas -

1. Great Himalaya
2. The Middle Himalayas
3. Shiwalik

According to the above options, the Great Himalaya is the oldest range of Himalayas (Oligocene Epoch-37-24 million years ago). After this, the Middle Himalayas (Miocene- 24-5 million years ago) and Shiwalik (Pliocene Epoch- 5-2 million years ago) is the newest range among them that was formed.

5. **If there were no Himalayan ranges, what would have been the most likely geographical impact on India?**

1. Much of the country would experience the cold waves from Siberia.
2. Indo-gangetic plain would be devoid of such extensive alluvial soils.
3. The pattern of monsoon would be different from what it is at present.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

If the Himalayan mountain range didn't most of India would have experienced cold waves coming from Siberia, the Indo-Gangetic Plain would have been deprived of such elaborate alluvial soil and the monsoon pattern would have been different from the present pattern. Significantly, the Himalayas influence the monsoon pattern as they effectively intercept the summer monsoons coming from the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea. It leads to precipitation in the form of rain. Also, the Indus, Ganga and their tributaries flowing from the Himalayan region create alluvial plains through erosion and deposition.

6. **The flat plains along the sub-Himalayan region in North India, are called –**

- (a) Tarai (b) Doon
(c) Khadar (d) Bhabar

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (d)

The flat plains along the sub-Himalayan region in North India, are called Bhabar. It is a narrow belt only 8 to 16 kms in width and lying parallel to the Shiwalik foothills at the break-up of the slope. This zone is studded with pebbles and it consists

of porous beds which have been laid down by the numerous streams as they descend down the hills. The porosity is so high that all streams lose themselves in the Bhabar. South of the Bhabar is the Tarai belt, with an approximate width of 15-30 km where most of the streams and rivers re-emerge without having any properly demarcated channel, thereby, creating marshy and swampy conditions known as the Tarai. This has a luxuriant growth of natural vegetation and houses a varied wildlife.

7. **The foothills region of Himalayas is –**

- (a) Trans-Himalayas (b) Shiwalik
(c) Great Himalayas (d) Aravali

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

The foothills region of the Himalayas is called Shiwalik. These are the outermost range of the Himalayas. They extend over a width of 10-50 km and have an altitude varying between 900 to 1100 meters. These ranges are composed of unconsolidated sediments brought down by rivers from the main Himalayan ranges located farther north.

8. **Shiwalik Hills are part of which of the following?**

- (a) Aravali (b) Western Ghats
(c) Himalaya (d) Satpura

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. **Shiwalik series was formed in –**

- (a) Eozoic (b) Paleozoic
(c) Mesozoic (d) Cenozoic

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Shiwalik or outer Himalaya has formed approximately 5-2 million years ago in the Pliocene Epoch, which means in the Cenozoic Era.

10. **The outermost range of the Himalayas is called as :**

- (a) Shiwaliks (b) Kumaon Himalayas
(c) Kashmir Himalayas (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. **The outermost range of the Himalayas is called as :**

- (a) Shiwaliks
(b) Kumaon Himalayas

- (c) Kashmir Himalayas
(d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. The altitude of Shiwalik peaks fall in between –

- (a) 850 – 1200 Mts (b) 750 – 1100 Mts
(c) 750 – 1500 Mts (d) 750 – 1300 Mts

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

Shiwalik range, spread over about 2500 km, is the southern range of Himalaya. Its average altitude is 900-1100 meters, although there is regional variation in the height of the Shiwalik ranges.

13. The Kumaon Himalaya is situated between which of the rivers?

- (a) Indus and Satluj
(b) Kali and Tista
(c) Satluj and Kali
(d) Tista and Brahmaputra

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2016

Ans. (c)

The Kumaon Himalaya is situated between the Satluj and Kali rivers. The geographic Himalayas' part between the Indus and Satluj rivers is called the 'Punjab Himalayas', the Himalayas between the Kali and Teesta rivers as the 'Nepal Himalaya', and the one between the Teesta and Dihang rivers is known as 'Assam Himalayas'.

14. The south of 'Shiwalik' rock series, Bhabar region is an example of -

- (a) Midland Situation.
(b) Intermountain situation.
(c) Piedmont situation.
(d) Littoral Region.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Bhabar region is a narrow belt ranging between 8-16 km parallel to the Shiwalik foothill at the break-up of the slope. As a result of this, the streams and rivers coming from the mountains deposit heavy material of rock and boulders. South of Bhabar is a Tarai belt with an approximate width of 15-30 km. Bhabar in the southern region of Shiwalik is an example of the Piedmont situation.

15. Correctly match the following :

(I)	(II)
A. North-Western Himalayas	1. Zaskar
B. Himachal and Uttarakhand Himalaya	2. Shivalik Range
C. Darjeeling and Sikkim Himalaya	3. Namcha Barwa
D. Arunachal Himalaya	4. Lepcha tribe

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	1	3	4
(c)	2	1	4	3
(d)	1	2	4	3

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre), 2022

Ans. (d)

Correct matches are as follows -

(I)	(II)
North-Western Himalayas	Zaskar
Himachal and Uttarakhand Himalaya	Shivalik Range
Darjeeling and Sikkim Himalaya	Lepcha tribe
Arunachal Himalaya	Namcha Barwa

16. When you travel in Himalayas, you will see the following

1. Deep gorges
2. U-turn river courses
3. Parallel mountain ranges
4. Steep gradients causing landsliding

Which of the above can be said to be the evidences for Himalayas being young fold mountains ?

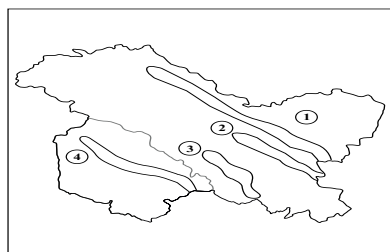
- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 4
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

All the above features are said to be an evidence for the Himalayas being young folded mountains. Deep gorges, U-turn river courses, Parallel mountain ranges and steep gradients causing landsliding are very common views in the Himalayas.

17. Examine the map of Jammu and Kashmir given below: The mountains ranges marked 1,2,3 and 4 respectively:



- (a) Ladakh, Zaskar, Karakoram and Pir Panjal
- (b) Karakoram, Pir Panjal, Zaskar and Ladakh
- (c) Karakoram, Ladakh, Zaskar and Pir Panjal
- (d) Ladakh, Pir Panjal, Karakoram and Zaskar

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

The mountain ranges marked 1,2,3 and 4 on the map of Jammu and Kashmir are :-

1. Karakoram ranges
2. Ladakh ranges
3. Zaskar ranges
4. Pir Panjal

18. What is the correct order of the following mountain ranges from North to South?

- A. Ladakh**
- B. Shiwalik**
- C. Karakoram**
- D. Zaskar**

Codes :

- (a) A, C, B, D
- (b) D, C, A, B
- (c) C, A, D, B
- (d) C, B, A, D

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The north to south order of mountain ranges is as follows :
Karakoram→Ladakh→Zaskar→Shiwalik.

19. The Lesser Himalaya is located between-

- (a) Trans Himalaya and Great Himalaya
- (b) Shiwalik and Great Himalaya
- (c) Trans Himalaya and Shiwalik
- (d) Shiwaliks and Outer Himalaya

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

The Himalayan Range consists of parallel mountain ranges. It includes Great Himalayas, Middle Himalaya and the Shiwalik. The mountain range which runs parallel between the Shiwalik in the south and the Great Himalayas in the north is classified as the Middle Himalayas, sometimes also called Lesser Himalaya or Himachal or Lower Himalayas. It has an intricate system of ranges that have an average width of 50 km having elevation varying from 3,700 to 4,500 m above sea level. Pir Panjal, the Dhauladhar, the Mussoorie Range, the Nag Tibba and Mahabharat are some of the important ranges of the Middle Himalaya.

20. Which of the following is the correct order of the Himalayan Ranges from south to north in the western section ?

- (a) Great Himalaya-Lesser Himalaya-Shiwalik
- (b) Shiwalik-Lesser Himalaya-Great Himalaya
- (c) Lesser Himalaya-Great Himalaya-Shiwalik
- (d) Shiwalik-Great Himalaya- Lesser Himalaya
- (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

The correct order of Himalayan Ranges in the western section from south to north is the Shiwalik-Lesser Himalaya-Great Himalaya.

21. Which one of the following is the youngest mountain chain ?

- (a) Vindhya
- (b) Aravalli
- (c) Shiwaliks
- (d) Annamalai

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

The Shiwalik Himalaya formed in the last stage of formation of Himalaya, thus they are considered as the youngest mountain range. It comprises the outermost range of the Himalayas and is also known as *outer Himalayas*. Flat scrapes, anticlinal crests and synclinal valleys are the chief characteristics of this range. The Shiwaliks are formed of great thickness of Mio-Pleistocene sand, gravels and conglomerates which have been brought by the rivers flowing from the higher ranges of the Himalayas. These have been folded and faulted by the earth movements. Shiwaliks have a different names in different areas like Jammu Hills in Jammu. Dafla, Miri, Abor and Mishmi Hills in Arunachal Pradesh.

22. Consider the following relief features –

- 1. Zaskar Range**
- 2. Dhauladhar Range**
- 3. Ladakh Range**
- 4. Karakoram Range**

The correct south to the northward sequence of the above relief features is

- (a) 2, 1, 3, 4
- (b) 2, 3, 4, 1
- (c) 4, 3, 2, 1
- (d) 4, 2, 1, 3

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

From south to northward, the correct sequence of the above options is: Dhauladhar Range, Zaskar Range, Ladakh Range and Karakoram. Karakoram, Ladakh and Zaskar Ranges are related to Trans Himalaya while Dhauladhar Range is situated in Lesser or Middle Himalaya .

23. Which one of the following is the correct northward sequence of the relief features?

- (a) Zaskar Range, Pirpanjal Range, Ladakh Range, Karakoram Range
- (b) Pirpanjal Range, Zaskar Range, Ladakh Range, Karakoram Range
- (c) Karakoram Range, Ladakh Range, Zaskar Range, Pirpanjal Range
- (d) Pirpanjal Range, Ladakh Range, Zaskar Range, Karakoram Range

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The correct northward sequence of the relief features is - Pirpanjal Range, Zaskar Range, Ladakh Range, Karakoram Range. Pirpanjal Range is situated in Middle Himalaya while the remaining are related to Trans Himalaya . Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.

24. Which one of the following groups is the correct sequence of mountain peaks from east to west?

- (a) Everest, Kanchenjunga, Annapurna, Dhaulagiri
- (b) Kanchenjunga, Everest, Annapurna, Dhaulagiri
- (c) Kanchenjunga, Dhaulagiri, Annapurna, Everest
- (d) Everest, Kanchenjunga, Dhaulagiri, Annapurna

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

The correct sequence of mountain peaks from east to west is: Kanchenjunga, Everest, Annapurna, Dhaulagiri. Kanchenjunga is the third tallest mountain in the world. Three of the five summits of the Kanchenjunga (main, central, and south) are situated on the boundary of the North Sikkim district in Sikkim, India and the Taplejung District in Nepal. The two other peaks are entirely situated in Taplejung District. Mt. Everest is the tallest mountain in the world above sea level. The elevation of Mount Everest is 8,848 meters (now 8848.86 m). The peak is situated in the Himalayas on the border of Nepal and China, which is also known as the Sagarmatha. The **Annapurna region** is an area in northcentral Nepal where some of the most popular treks are located. Dhaulagiri Peak is also located in West Central Nepal, west of Annapurna Peak.

25. Which mountain range amongst the following is latest in origin?

- (a) Ajanta range
- (b) Palkonda range
- (c) Kaimur Hills
- (d) Patkai range

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Patkai Range is originated in the tertiary era. The remaining ranges/hills are situated in South and Central India . Thus the latest mountain range is Patkai Range.

26. Which one of the following states does not lie along Patkai hills?

- (a) Nagaland
- (b) Tripura
- (c) Manipur
- (d) Mizoram

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

The Patkai hills are situated on India's northeastern border with Myanmar. The Indian states along Patkai hills are Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram and Nagaland. Tripura does not lie along Patkai hills. Mizo hills stretch through Mizoram and Tripura.

27. Pir Panjal Range is located/found in-

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh
- (b) Jammu and Kashmir
- (c) Punjab
- (d) Uttarakhand

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

Pir Panjal Range is located in the Middle Himalaya. It is spread in Himachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir from southeast to northwest.

28. Consider the following statements regarding 'Atal Tunnel' Which of them is / are correct?

1. It was built by the Border Roads Organisation.
2. It connects Manali and Lahaul Spiti Valley
3. It is located across Pir-Panjal Range of Himalayas
4. It is strategically important for India

Choose the correct answer from the code given below.

Code :

- (a) Only 1 and 2
- (b) Only 2 and 3
- (c) Only 1, 2 and 4
- (d) All 1, 2, 3 and 4

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

Atal Tunnel is across Eastern Pir Panjal Range. It connects Manali and Lahaul-Spiti Valley. It is 9.02 km long and was built by Border Roads Organisation (BRO). The tunnel reduces the distance by 46 km between Manali and Leh and the travel time by about 4 to 5 hours. Strategically, it provides better connectivity to the armed forces in reaching Ladakh.

29. What is the length of the Atal Tunnel, Rohtang, Himachal Pradesh?

- (a) 8.02 km
- (b) 9.02 km
- (c) 1002 km
- (d) 1102 km
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

30. Atal Tunnel is across which one of the following Himalayan ranges?

- (a) Zaskar
- (b) Western Pir Panjal
- (c) Ladakh
- (d) Eastern Pir Panjal
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

31. Between which two mountain ranges is the Valley of Kashmir situated?

- (a) Ladakh and Zaskar
- (b) Great Himalayas and Pir Panjal
- (c) Great Himalayas and Zaskar
- (d) Karakoram and Ladakh

M.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Kashmir Valley is bounded on the southwest by Pir Panjal Range and on the northeast by Great Himalayan (Himadri) Range.

32. Valley of Kashmir is situated between:

- (a) Kangara and Dhauladhar ranges
- (b) Pir Panjal and Himadri ranges
- (c) Mahabharat and Dhauladhar ranges
- (d) Pir Panjal and Mahabharat ranges

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

33. Which of the following is a part of Aksai Chin region:

- (a) Karakoram Range
- (b) Shiwalik Range
- (c) Kashmir Valley
- (d) Ladakh Plateau

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

Aksai Chin is spread over about 38000 square kilometers in Ladakh region. It is an Indian territory under the occupation of China.

34. What is the height of Great Himalaya ?

- (a) 8850 m Above sea level
- (b) 8815 m Above sea level
- (c) 8890 m Above sea level
- (d) 8860 m Above sea level

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

The average height of the Great Himalaya is about 6000m while the height of its highest peak, Mount Everest is approximately 8850 m. Note : Nepal and China jointly announced the new height of Mount Everest as 8848.86 meters.

35. Himachal stands for -

- (a) The Great Himalaya
- (b) The Middle Himalaya
- (c) Shiwalik
- (d) Trans-Himalaya

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

The Middle Himalayas form the most intricate and rugged mountainous system, with an average width of 50 km and on elevation of 3700-4500m. Most of the hill stations like Shimla, Nainital and Mussoorie are located in this range.

36. Consider the following statements:

- 1. In India, the Himalayas are spread over five States only.
- 2. Western Ghats are spread over five States only.
- 3. Pulicat Lake is spread over two states only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1 and 3 only

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

The Himalayas are spread over most of the northern and northeastern states & UTs i.e., Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura. Besides these, the hill region of Assam and West Bengal are also part of the Himalayas. So, Himalayas are spread over more than five states. The Western Ghats are spread over the states of Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Kerala i.e., 6 states. Pulicat Lake is the second largest (after Chilika Lake) lagoon in India, straddling the border of Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh. Therefore statements 1 and 2 are wrong and statement 3 is correct.

37. The Himalayan Mountain Ranges are not a part of which of the following states?

- (a) Uttarakhand (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Sikkim (d) Himachal Pradesh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

The Indian Himalayan Region (IHR) spreads across 9 states (administrative regions) namely, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura & 2 UTs - Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh and hill regions of 2 states viz. Assam and West Bengal. On the other hand the expansion of Uttar Pradesh lies only in the plain regions. So the Himalayan Mountain Ranges are not a part of Uttar Pradesh.

38. Which of the following ranges is the most recent one?

- (a) Aravallis (b) Vindhya Range
(c) The Himalayas (d) The Eastern Ghats

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The Himalayan range is an example of a young folded mountain range and is the most youngest range among the given options. The Aravalli Range is the most ancient mountain range in India. Notably, the Great Himalayas are also called the Himadri range.

39. Which one of the following is the youngest mountain range of India?

- (a) Himadri Range (b) Aravalli Range
(c) Western Ghat (d) Vindhya Range

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

The Himadri Range is an example of the new fold mountain and is the youngest mountain range in India among the above mentioned options. The Aravalli Range is the oldest mountain Range in India.

40. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : The highest concentration of Seismic zones lies in Himalayan region in India.

Reason (R) : There are many longitudinal thrust zones in Himalayas.

Codes :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false

(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The highest concentration of seismic zones in India lies in the Himalayan region. Most of the area lies in seismic zones IV and V. Under this region, the area of Northeast India, Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand is included. So we can say that the highest concentration of seismic zones lies in the Himalayan region in India. Hence, statement (a) is correct.

Many longitudinal thrusts and faults lie in the Himalayas. The Main Frontal Thrust (MFT) lies when moving from south to north. Between MFT and MBF (Main Boundary Fault), there is an extension of Sub-Himalayan (Shiwalik). Between MBF and MCT (Main Central Thrust) there is an extension of the Lesser Himalayas. Above this is the extension of Greater Himalayas, which is also known as the CCZ (Central Crystalline Zone). HHC (Higher Himalayan Crystalline) is located above the MCT. Tibet Himalaya is situated between HHC and STDS (South Tibetan Detachment System). The Himalaya lies to the north of ITSA. Due to the location of the reverse region and the Himalayan geographical structure, it becomes the most concentrated earthquake zone in India. Due to the operation of plates in this area, it is an earthquake-prone area.

41. 'Imphal Basin' surrounded by Manipur hills is a fine example of -

- (a) Lacustrine plain (b) Loess plain
(c) Glacial plain (d) Alluvial plain

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Due to the existence of a lake in the past, the plain formed by sediment deposition is called lacustrine plains. Kashmir valley and Imphal basin are the best examples of this.

42. With reference to the Himalayan range, which of the statements is/are correct?

1. The sedimentary rocks of the greater Himalayas were fossilless.
2. Marine living fossils are found in the sedimentary rocks of lesser Himalayas.
3. Remains of human civilization are found in outer or Shiwalik Himalayas.